

BEFORE YOU BUY**any purchase over \$500**

1. Can I pay cash without touching the emergency fund?
2. What does it cost per MONTH to own — not just to buy?
3. What would this money become if invested instead? (flip the formula card)
4. Have I priced three alternatives, including used?
5. Fixed, variable, periodic, or discretionary — which envelope pays?
6. If it breaks in a year, can I afford it twice?
7. Am I buying price, or value? Better is always better.
8. Do I still want it after 72 hours?

Look it up: [investor.gov calculator](https://www.investor.gov/calculator) · $\text{price} \div \text{amount} = \text{unit price}$ · your own budget sheet.

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